

FIELD LIBRARY / FULL FIELD GUIDE

Civil unrest

CONFLICT / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Move away from violence or dangerous crowd movement by a safe route, or shelter in a secure place if movement is riskier. Avoid confrontation, keep family members together and check the actual conditions on your route. Do not assume official presence makes an area safe. If authorities are involved in threats, seek independently verified local or humanitarian help when safe.

Do now.

- ☐ **Separate the event from your location**
01 Check what is happening on your route, not just citywide headlines. Peaceful assembly and a nearby dangerous incident are different conditions.
- ☐ **Choose a safe path**
02 Move away from active violence and blocked roads. If there is no safe exit, shelter inside, away from windows, and update a trusted contact.
- ☐ **Stay informed**
03 Use official local notices for curfews, transport changes, and emergency services, and verify unconfirmed social posts before acting.
- ☐ **Regroup deliberately**
04 Arrange a meeting point and a backup contact if mobile networks are strained. Wait for reliable updates before returning to a disrupted area.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Use what you can see safely from your location to judge immediate danger; do not approach a crowd to investigate. Agree on a place to regroup away from the disturbance. If officials or armed personnel are involved in threats, use trusted private contacts or independently verified humanitarian help when safe.

Watch for.

Do not assume a protest is violent or that a citywide alert applies equally to every neighborhood. If an order applies, read its location, hours, and exceptions.

People & practical needs.

Choose two reunion places and an out-of-area contact. Keep children with a trusted caregiver and carry a written contact card. Share sensitive addresses and travel details only with people who need them; avoid posting live locations or images of other families without consent. For this situation, brief every person on the first action: separate the event from your location. Agree who will manage children, pets or mobility needs while that action happens. Do not assume a protest is violent or that a citywide alert applies equally to every neighborhood. If an order applies, read its location, hours, and exceptions.

Keep essentials within reach.

For civil unrest, prioritize only items needed for the first action and the fallback: Use what you can see safely from your location to judge immediate danger; do not approach a crowd to investigate. Agree on a place to regroup away from the disturbance. If officials or armed personnel are involved in threats, use trusted private contacts or independently verified humanitarian help when safe. Keep the relevant checklist and contact information within reach. Equipment retrieval must not delay the protective step.

Next decisions.

Before going out, check whether your route crosses a closure and identify an alternative. Carry basic identification, necessary medication, and phone power.

First decision: Separate the event from your location

Check what is happening on your route, not just citywide headlines. Peaceful assembly and a nearby dangerous incident are different conditions. Decide which person can carry this out immediately and what would prevent it in your current location. Do not delay the protective step to complete a household worksheet.

When the original plan fails

Use what you can see safely from your location to judge immediate danger; do not approach a crowd to investigate. Agree on a place to regroup away from the disturbance. If officials or armed personnel are involved in threats, use trusted private contacts or independently verified humanitarian help when safe. Reassess the next available location or resource using the warning signs in this guide; do not assume a promised service is operating.

Before changing location

Do not assume a protest is violent or that a citywide alert applies equally to every neighborhood. If an order applies, read its location, hours, and exceptions. Check the actual route and the needs of the person who will have the most difficulty moving. A destination is not confirmed until access and conditions have been checked.

Questions in the field.

What matters before collecting supplies?

Move away from violence or dangerous crowd movement by a safe route, or shelter in a secure place if movement is riskier. Avoid confrontation, keep family members together and check the actual conditions on your route. Do not assume official presence makes an area safe. If authorities are involved in threats, seek independently verified local or humanitarian help when safe. Collect items only if doing so does not delay this action.

What should another household member do?

Use a second person to handle communication or dependents while the first carries out the immediate action. For civil unrest, keep the specific hazard in view: Do not assume a protest is violent or that a citywide alert applies equally to every neighborhood. If an order applies, read its location, hours, and exceptions.

What should be written down?

Record when the situation changed, what action was taken and what remains uncertain. For this situation, start with: Regroup deliberately. Arrange a meeting point and a backup contact if mobile networks are strained. Wait for reliable updates before returning to a disrupted area. Keep personal notes private; they are not submitted to Osprey Zero.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

NEXT ACTION / PERSON RESPONSIBLE

Sources & limits.

Civilian educational guidance. Linked references may use U.S. emergency systems; local warning methods, laws, services and conditions differ.

Source-linked editorial guidance. Not independent clinical or specialist certification. Training and product-specific instructions remain essential.

[U.S. State Department · Global events and travel](#)

<https://travel.state.gov/en/international-travel/travel-advisories/global-events.html>

[Ready.gov · Emergency alerts](#)

<https://www.ready.gov/alerts>

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/civil-unrest/>

Content updated 2026-10-02. Saved guidance cannot provide live alerts.